

UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR)

Source page: <https://www.gov.uk/data-protection>

This PDF is a printable extract of the GOV.UK data protection page that states UK data protection is governed by the UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR) and the Data Protection Act 2018.

Data protection: The UK's data protection legislation - GOV.UK

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The UK's data protection legislation

Data protection legislation controls how your personal information is used by organisations, including businesses and government departments.

In the UK, data protection is governed by the

UK General Data Protection Regulation (UK GDPR)

and the

Data Protection Act 2018

.

Everyone responsible for using personal data has to follow strict rules called 'data protection principles' unless an exemption applies. There is a

guide to the data protection exemptions on the Information Commissioner's Office (

ICO

) website

.

Anyone responsible for using personal data must make sure the information is:

used fairly, lawfully and transparently

used for specified, explicit purposes

used in a way that is adequate, relevant and limited to only what is necessary

accurate and, where necessary, kept up to date

kept for no longer than is necessary

handled in a way that ensures appropriate security, including protection against unlawful or unauthorised processing, access, loss, destruction or damage

There is stronger legal protection for more sensitive information, such as:

race

ethnic background

political opinions

religious beliefs

trade union membership

genetics

biometrics (where used for identification)

health

sex life or orientation

There are separate safeguards for personal data relating to criminal convictions and offences.

Your rights

Under the legislation, you have rights in relation to your personal data, with some exceptions. These include the right to:

be informed about how your data is being used

access personal data

have incorrect data updated

have data erased

stop or restrict the processing of your data

data portability (allowing you to get and reuse your data for different services)

object to how your data is processed in certain circumstances

You also have rights when an organisation is using your personal data for:

automated decision-making processes (without human involvement)

profiling, for example to predict your behaviour or interests

If you're concerned about how an organisation is handling your personal data

Contact the

ICO

for advice or to make a complaint.

ICO

Telephone: 0303 123 1113

Textphone: 18001 0303 123 1113

Monday to Friday, 9am to 5pm

Find out about call charges

Information Commissioner's Office

Wycliffe House

Water Lane

Wilmslow

Cheshire

SK9 5AF

You can find more contact details on the

ICO

website

.

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Explore the topic

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